DEC10 · INTERACTIVE DISCUSSION

How Your Discussion Is Marked

Student guide to the Interactive Discussion rubric

Student _____ Class _____ Teacher _____

4 skills each get a score · Scores go from **50 or less** to **76 or more** · Final score = the **average** of the 4 skills

1 Argumentation Skills

Share clear ideas and build a strong argument

WHAT TO DO

- **Ideas**
  Make your key points clear. Explain them and give examples.
- **Argumentation**
  Respond to others: restate, evaluate, ask probing questions and challenge their ideas politely.
- **Critical thinking**
  Compare other people's views with yours, then state your own position clearly.

WHAT EACH LEVEL LOOKS LIKE

Developing · 60 or less	Ideas are sometimes unclear or have few examples. You respond to others only a little.
Good · 61–70	Clear ideas with some detail. You explain your position and evaluate others' ideas.
Excellent · 71 or more	A strong, well-developed argument. You persuade and think critically.

2 Engagement & Interaction

Take part, answer questions and work as a group

WHAT TO DO

- **Individual questions**
  Answer your questions clearly, relevantly and without long hesitation.
- **Source selection**
  Choose relevant information from your research and use it well.
- **Group discussion**
  Join in often, take turns and help the group discuss the task together.

WHAT EACH LEVEL LOOKS LIKE

Developing · 60 or less	Answering questions is hard for you. You take part and take turns very little.
Good · 61–70	Your answers are relevant and fairly fluent. You take part with good turn-taking.
Excellent · 71 or more	You answer confidently and accurately and engage the group effectively.

3 Pronunciation & Flow

Be easy to understand

WHAT TO DO

- **Sounds, stress, intonation**
  Say sounds clearly, stress key words and use natural intonation.
- **Speech flow**
  Keep going. If you get stuck, say it another way.
- **Cohesion**
  Link your ideas with connectors (e.g., however, for example, as a result).

WHAT EACH LEVEL LOOKS LIKE

Developing · 60 or less	Listeners need effort to understand you. Some parts are unclear.
Good · 61–70	Your speech is usually clear and listeners understand your message.
Excellent · 71 or more	Your speech is clear and easy to understand all the time.

4 Language Use

Use a good range of accurate language

WHAT TO DO

- **Range & formality**
  Use polite, formal language that suits an academic discussion.
- **Vocabulary**
  Use a wide range of words. If you don't know a word, explain it another way.
- **Grammar**
  Use simple and complex sentences with few mistakes.

WHAT EACH LEVEL LOOKS LIKE

Developing · 60 or less	Your language range is limited. Mistakes sometimes change the meaning.
Good · 61–70	A good range. You reword to fill gaps. Only small mistakes.
Excellent · 71 or more	A wide range of language with accurate, precise choices.

My scores

from my teacher

Argumentation	Engagement	Pronunciation	Language	Average

Tip: good discussions are a team effort. Listen carefully, build on what others say, and give your own clear opinion.

Your teacher marks you with the full rubric.